

Application & Interview Prep Checklist

Companion to the Master Checklist (tech skills) and DSA_Master_Checklist (CP/DSA). This one covers the application-facing side of placement prep: profile, resume, core CS/HR, explaining your work, communication, aptitude, and the application process itself.

Section 1: Professional Profile Optimization

LinkedIn

- ☐ Update with summer vacation work (Shard/Cairn, Conclave, Foundry, etc.)
- ☐ Headline — role-targeted, not just "Student at GNIOT"
- ☐ About section rewritten
- ☐ Experience entries synced with resume
- ☐ Featured section — link 2–3 strongest repos/demos
- ☐ Start a regular posting cadence (build-in-public style: milestones, learnings)

GitHub

- ☐ Update pinned repos + profile README with summer work
- ☐ Add a short description to every repo (one-liner under repo name, not the README)
- ☐ Every pinned repo has a real README (problem, tech stack, screenshots/demo link)
- ☐ Regular commit cadence, not just at deadlines

Portfolio + Blog Site (mirrors LinkedIn structure)

- ☐ Rebuild locally on own stack (own repo, own domain, full control — moving off AI Studio)
- ☐ Home / Headline
- ☐ About
- ☐ Experience (IBM-PBEL, synced with LinkedIn/resume)
- ☐ Featured Projects
- ☐ Skills
- ☐ Blog (replaces LinkedIn's post feed — project writeups, learnings)
- ☐ Deploy + connect domain

Other Platforms

- ☐ Explore X and Bluesky — decide if active or just claimed
- ☐ Job portals updated (per existing portal doc)
- ☐ Freelance site profile set up (for fun/side income, lower priority)

Section 2: Resume Creation

- ☐ Master content doc — all project bullets, experience, etc. in one place; grammatically clean, doesn't read as AI-generated
- ☐ Base resumes per track — pre-built versions per resume track (Java Backend, Python Backend, AI Engineer, etc.) with that track's assigned projects already slotted in
- ☐ Bullet library per project (2–3 variants each) for fast tailoring

- ☐ Tailoring pass before each application — fine-tune relevant base resume, then update LinkedIn/GitHub/portfolio simultaneously
- ☐ ATS-safe formatting — no tables, text boxes, or graphics that break parsing
- ☐ Standard, parseable fonts
- ☐ One page — hard limit, regardless of how many projects exist in the master doc
- ☐ PDF export tested through an ATS checker/parser

Note: Master content doc = source repository (unlimited length). Every applied resume stays one page, assembled by selecting from the repository per job description.

Section 3: Core CS / HR Interview Prep

Operating Systems

- ☐ Process vs Thread, process states, context switching
- ☐ CPU Scheduling (FCFS, SJF, Round Robin, Priority)
- ☐ Deadlock (conditions, prevention, avoidance)
- ☐ Memory Management (paging, segmentation, virtual memory, thrashing)
- ☐ Synchronization (semaphores, mutex, producer-consumer)

Computer Networks

- ☐ OSI vs TCP/IP model
- ☐ TCP vs UDP
- ☐ HTTP/HTTPS, DNS, how a URL resolves end-to-end
- ☐ IP addressing basics

Cross-referenced (already covered in Master Checklist)

- ☐ DBMS — Phase 5
- ☐ OOP — Phase 2

HR & Resume-Based

- ☐ Classic HR questions (strengths/weaknesses, why this company, where do you see yourself, why should we hire you)
- ☐ Resume-based Q&A; — prep an answer for every bullet on the resume

Note: Kept at fresher-interview conceptual depth, not full GATE computational depth.

Section 4: Explaining Your Work

- ☐ Convert existing project docs (README/roadmap/learning docs) into a spoken narrative — practice explaining out loud from what's already written
- ☐ Per project: why this decision over the alternative, what you'd change at scale, one real debugging story
- ☐ IBM-PBEL — same structure, framed around specific contribution vs team's
- ☐ Test live — explain a project to someone unscripted, note what was confusing

Section 5: Communication (soft skills only)

- [] Spoken English practice — daily short-form (read aloud, shadow a podcast/talk, record yourself)
- [] Mock interviews — with a friend or on a platform, not just self-rehearsal
- [] Group discussion practice, if placement drives include GDs
- [] Answering under pressure — practice thinking out loud instead of long silent pauses
- [] Feedback loop — record yourself or get a friend's honest read after each mock

Section 6: Aptitude Prep

- [] One timed mock test to confirm baseline
- [] Brush up weak areas only, based on that mock
- [] No dedicated heavy prep block — light-touch section given existing college aptitude classes

Section 7: Application Process (final step)

4 Priority Channels

- [] Cold mail — direct outreach to companies/recruiters
- [] Job portals — Naukri, Internshala, LinkedIn Jobs, etc.
- [] Company career pages — applying directly
- [] On-campus drives — through college placement cell

Tracking (via Trajectory)

- [] Log every application: company, role, channel, track/resume variant used, date, status
- [] Track which base resume + featured project was sent per application